

be restarted. There are way too many add-ons (or Extensions) for us to go into here; what follows is a description of a selection of add-ons recommended by the Firefox team.

Adblock Plus

The most popular Add-on, Adblock optionally uses a publicly-maintained list of ad servers to block content from them. This list can be complemented with individual preferences. It can also selectively block Web page content from loading. Right-click on a Web page object (image or flash animation) that is undesirable, and select the Adblock option to prevent it from loading the next time.

To configure Adblock plus, check the relevant entry under the Tools menu. To add a new entry, select the Add Filter button and enter the URL of the site you would like to prevent from sending data. If you would like to prevent a group of sites sharing similar URLs, you can use wildcards. For example, if `adserver.net/ads/`, `adhit.com/ads/`, and `advertise.org/ads/` are to be blocked, you can add `*/ads/*` as a filter.

For a no-fuss experience, also install the Adblock Filterset.G Updater add-on. Your ad server list will get updated all by itself, with the end result just being that you won't see any ads at all!

NoScript

This add-on can be used to block various elements like JavaScript, Java, and plugins including Flash from Web pages. Since scripting is the preferred way of hijacking a system, NoScript greatly improves the security profile of Firefox. The user can selectively configure NoScript to allow certain Web sites to run scripts while preventing others from doing so. By default, NoScript informs the user every time a script is prevented from running.

Fasterfox

This add-on purports to tweak Firefox to speed up browsing. It achieves this by changing browser and network settings like browser cache size and HTTP parameters. By default, Fasterfox